

DIAL ECOSYSTEM

Comprehensive Master Business Plan, Operations Strategy,
Marketing Plan, Investor Case & Technical Blueprint

Find it. Buy it. Get it done.

August 2026 | Comprehensive Edition (Including Fleet & Core Enhancements)

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PART I - BUSINESS STRATEGY

1. Vision, Mission and Strategic Identity

Vision: become Zimbabwe's trusted digital operating system for vehicle ownership, spare parts, skilled services, maintenance, protection, fleet management, and roadside assistance.

Mission: connect customers to the right products and verified professionals through transparent discovery, secure payments, accountable fulfilment and excellent service.

DIAL is a managed marketplace. It owns the customer journey and coordinates trust, verification, pricing, payment, fulfilment, support and accountability rather than merely publishing listings. The strategic principle is that WhatsApp is an additional high-conversion sales and service channel within a broader mobile-and-web e-commerce environment. It is not the primary product and does not replace the customer apps, supplier portal, technician app, web marketplace or central operating platform.

2. The Customer Problems

Vehicle owners face fragmented suppliers, uncertain stock, counterfeit or unsuitable parts, poor part identification, inconsistent prices, limited delivery and weak after-sales accountability.

Customers seeking mechanics, auto electricians, plumbers, electricians, cleaners, hairdressers, nail technicians and other artisans often depend on informal referrals with little evidence of competence, character, punctuality, availability or workmanship.

Suppliers and professionals need dependable demand, secure payment, digital distribution, reputation tools and efficient administration.

Fleet Operators: Multi-vehicle owners (commercial and individual) lack consolidated dashboards for maintenance scheduling, lifecycle tracking, and unified billing, leading to operational downtime and administrative friction.

3. The DIAL Ecosystem

- **Dial a Spare:** multi-supplier parts discovery, fitment support, anonymous offers, checkout, collection, delivery, returns and settlement.
- **Dial a Tech:** vetted technicians and service professionals, live availability, proximity-aware discovery, booking, protected payments, job evidence, ratings, reviews and disputes.
- **Dial Fleet:** Dedicated management for multi-vehicle owners covering consolidated procurement, preventative maintenance scheduling, asset depreciation reports, and priority dispatch.
- **Vehicle Hub:** digital vehicle garage, service history, reminders, insurance and licence/permit expiry tracking.
- **Dial Care:** monthly vehicle-care plans with different benefit levels.
- **Dial Assist:** breakdown, roadside, towing and emergency coordination.
- **Insurance and authorised service partnerships:** digital acquisition, renewals, customer engagement and service-network value.

4. Value Proposition

Customers & Fleets: one trusted place to find parts, compare verified offers, book professionals, pay securely, track work, manage multiple assets, and retain a digital service history.

Suppliers: new demand, controlled customer acquisition, predictable settlement, stock tools and performance analytics.

Technicians: no subscription, access to customers, payment assurance, professional identity, digital reputation and performance-based opportunity.

Partners: measurable customer acquisition, digital distribution, service fulfilment and customer-retention capabilities.

PART II - OPERATING MODEL & BUSINESS MANAGEMENT

5. Dial a Spare Supplier Model

Use a supplier net-price model. Suppliers submit the amount they expect to receive; DIAL adds platform margin, delivery, payment costs and applicable charges to create the customer price. Do not show supplier names to customers. Present offers by product brand, condition, warranty, availability, delivery estimate and neutral identifiers.

Algorithmic Badging: Expand neutral identifiers with dynamic performance badges (e.g., "Highest Fitment Match," "Fastest Dispatch") to incentivize supplier excellence. Supplier confidence is built through written agreements, clear settlement rules, transparent statements, predictable payout schedules, order notifications and a supplier dashboard.

6. Payment Routing and Supplier Settlement

Preferred model: customer pays DIAL through an authorised payment provider; the transaction ledger immediately records supplier payable, DIAL revenue, delivery payable, provider fees and taxes; supplier funds are released after the agreed fulfilment event. Where a provider supports marketplace split payments, use provider-native routing. Where it does not, use a controlled platform ledger and scheduled settlement subject to legal, tax, payment-provider and safeguarding advice.

Alternative early-stage model: customer pays supplier directly and DIAL invoices commission periodically. Settlement triggers should distinguish confirmed order, supplier ready, collected, delivered, customer acceptance, return window and dispute hold.

7. Parts Catalogue and Inventory Workaround

Do not wait for a complete national catalogue. Start with an assisted request and quotation engine while building a supplier-independent master catalogue in parallel. Master data should include standard names, categories, OEM numbers, aftermarket cross-references, vehicle make/model/generation, engine, transmission, drivetrain, fitment rules and installation position.

EPC Integration: Aggressively bootstrap the master parts catalogue by programmatically integrating reverse-engineered electronic parts catalog (EPC) data to cross-reference supplier SKUs instantly.

8. Parts Fulfilment and Logistics

Workflow: request/search → fitment validation → offers → customer selection → payment → supplier confirmation → collection → delivery → acceptance → settlement.

Use pickup verification, QR or order codes, item photographs, chain-of-custody events and proof of delivery.

Hardware Integration: Integrate Bluetooth thermal printing capabilities into the supplier portal to instantly generate standardized, QR-coded dispatch labels upon order confirmation. Leverage native QR code scanning bridges in the logistics apps to minimize scan-failure rates.

Begin with contracted couriers and controlled delivery zones. Build an internal dispatch capability only when volume supports it. Define return rules by product type, condition, fitment error, supplier fault, customer error and warranty.

9. Dial a Tech Vetting and Onboarding

Verify identity, address or operating area, references, qualifications, trade experience, portfolio, tools, mobility and background checks. Use trade-specific practical assessments for high-risk categories (e.g., advanced diagnostics for electricians and millwrights). Start new professionals on probation. Require signed platform agreements, code of conduct, and pricing rules. Issue branded workwear and QR-enabled identification after approval.

10. Technician Profile, Availability and Matching

Profile cards include profile picture, approved display name, trade, bio, experience, specialties, qualifications, jobs undertaken, completion rate, star rating, reviews, response time, punctuality, mobility, service area and availability. Matching filters by trade, verification, location, equipment, urgency and customer constraints. Show approximate distance before booking.

11. Technician Job and Payment Model

For small jobs, collect the agreed fee or an approved deposit, secure it, and release it after completion confirmation. For larger projects, use approved quotations and milestone payments. For emergency work, collect a call-out fee first. DIAL deducts its commission automatically before technician payout.

12. Disputes, Workmanship and Customer Protection

Use structured dispute categories, evidence deadlines, job records, before-and-after media, messages, receipts, checklists and reviewer decisions. **Mandatory Compliance:** The technician app enforces the capture of timestamped, offline-tolerant before-and-after photographs. Failure to follow this workflow defaults disputes in favor of the customer.

Dial Verified Workmanship Protection applies only to defined trades, vetted providers, on-platform bookings and documented claims within the stated period.

13. Preventing Off-Platform Collusion

Automatic commission deduction is the primary control. Control contact exchange before booking where practical. Monitor repeated cancellations, direct-payment complaints, and unusually low platform completion. Use compliance as an internal performance factor affecting ranking.

14. Management Structure and Operating Departments

Executive and strategy; product and technology; supplier and catalogue operations; technician verification and quality; customer support and dispute resolution; finance, settlement and reconciliation; logistics and fulfilment; marketing and partnerships; legal, compliance and risk; data and business intelligence.

PART III - MARKETING & GROWTH STRATEGY

15. Brand Positioning & 16. Customer Acquisition

Position DIAL around trust, convenience, professionalism and accountability: Find it. Buy it. Get it done. Use Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, Google search, WhatsApp click-to-chat, vehicle communities, workshops, fleet operators, and local business partnerships. Create educational content around vehicle problems.

17. Supplier Acquisition & 18. Technician Acquisition

Approach reputable parts suppliers with a clear commercial pack: new demand, supplier anonymity, controlled pricing, and dashboard reporting. Recruit technicians through trade associations, vocational institutions, referrals and targeted social campaigns. Run onboarding days and practical assessments.

19. Partnerships & 20. Retention and Growth Flywheel

Insurance companies for digital acquisition and renewals. **Fleets and Employers:** Early targeting of commercial fleets guarantees a baseline volume of both parts procurement and technician bookings. Workshops, dealerships, tow operators, couriers, and fuel stations for distribution. Use personalised reminders for service intervals and licence expiry via Vehicle Hub.

PART IV - PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT, TRUST & QUALITY

21. Professional Code of Conduct & 22. Field Service Standards

Technicians must arrive on time, wear branded workwear, display identification, communicate respectfully, and obtain approval before extra work. No harassment, theft, or unsafe conduct. Use check-in/check-out, customer greeting, job-scope confirmation, progress updates, and completion checklists.

23. Quality Management

Create trade-specific standard operating procedures, checklists and acceptance criteria. Audit a sample of completed jobs and investigate repeated complaints. Use a technician quality score combining customer ratings, objective completion data, punctuality, disputes, rework, safety and compliance.

PART V - FINANCE, GOVERNANCE & INVESTMENT

24. Revenue and Unit Economics

Dial a Spare: margin/commission, delivery margin, premium sourcing. Dial a Tech: booking fee, transaction commission, protection/admin fee. Dial Fleet/Care: monthly recurring membership and enterprise billing. Track gross merchandise value, take rate, payment costs, delivery cost, contribution margin, CAC, and LTV.

25. Investment Requirement and Use & 26. Governance

Indicative allocation: 35% product and technology; 20% launch/customer acquisition; 15% supplier/technician network; 10% operations; 10% legal/compliance; 10% working capital. Use advisory oversight, maintain approval limits, procurement controls, audit trails, and obtain specialist Zimbabwean advice.

PART VI - TECHNICAL BLUEPRINT

27. Multi-Platform Product Architecture

Customer app and web marketplace are primary channels. Technician app is the operational field tool. Supplier portal manages stock, quotations, orders and settlements. Admin portal manages the ecosystem. WhatsApp Flows is an additional conversational channel that uses the same backend services.

28. Modular Backend Domains & 29. Client Applications

Domains include identity, vehicle garage, supplier/technician management, verification, master catalogue, fitment, inventory, orders, payments, ledger, delivery, and reporting. Customer app features onboarding, parts search, bookings. Technician app features job feeds, quotes, check-ins, and **offline-tolerant syncing** for remote areas.

30. WhatsApp Flows as an Additional Channel

WhatsApp supports Find a Spare and Book a Tech journeys, validating fitment, returning anonymous offers, initiating secure payments, and tracking statuses. It must not contain the financial source of truth.

31. Catalogue, Fitment & 32. Payment Architecture

Master products use EPC cross-references, vehicle variants, and fitment rules. Supplier products map to master products. Use provider-neutral payment adapters. Every financial event creates immutable double-entry ledger entries (authorisation, hold, release, settlement).

33. Orders, Jobs and Workflow Engines & 34. Location

Use state machines so invalid transitions are impossible and every transition is auditable. Technicians control availability; location updates are consent-based and battery-aware. Precise location sharing is time-limited.

35. Ratings, Security & 37. Integration Architecture

Public ratings cover workmanship and satisfaction; internal scores track rework and cancellations. Implement role-based access, tokenised payments, audit logs, and OpenAPI documentation for external integrations.

38. Recommended Technology Stack (Enhanced)

- **Mobile Apps:** Native Android applications built primarily using [Kotlin and Jetpack Compose](#) for maximum performance, fluid animations, and deep device hardware access (crucial for native QR scanning).
- **Backend & Database:** Utilize [Supabase](#) to handle complex PostgreSQL state machines, real-time database syncing, and edge functions to drastically reduce MVP time-to-market.
- **Web:** React/Next.js for the supplier and administration portals.
- **Hardware:** Seamless Bluetooth integration for standard thermal printers and edge-device telemetry for enterprise fleet monitoring.

39. Development Phases

Phase 0: Research, prototyping. Phase 1: Foundation (Kotlin app shells, Supabase setup, EPC catalogue ingestion). Phase 2: Controlled MVP (Harare launch, onboard fleets). Phase 3: Marketplace hardening. Phase 4 & 5: Ecosystem expansion and national scale.

PART VII - ROADMAP, KPIs & RISK

40. Core KPIs & 41. Key Risks and Mitigation

Demand (CAC, LTV, Active Customers), Parts (GMV, Fill Rate, Returns), Tech (Booking Conversion, Dispute Rate, On-platform completion), and Finance (Take rate, net revenue). Key risks include stock inaccuracy, wrong parts, supplier distrust, poor workmanship, and commission leakage, mitigated by strict vetting, automated deductions, and EPC data.

42. Final Strategic Recommendation

Launch as a focused managed marketplace in Harare. Prove the operating model with selected parts and priority trades. Treat trust operations as core product capabilities. Scale only after unit economics, supplier confidence, technician quality, and customer retention are demonstrated.

Appendices

Appendix A: Indicative Revenue Matrix

Business Unit	Primary Revenue	Additional Revenue
Dial a Spare	Margin / supplier commission	Delivery, promotion, supplier tools
Dial a Tech	Completed-job commission	Booking fee, protection admin fee
Dial Fleet/Care	Monthly membership / SaaS	Premium benefits, SLA prioritization
Vehicle Hub	Premium features	Cross-sell and retention value

Appendix B: Professional Launch Checklist

Company structure, supplier contracts, technician agreements, customer terms, payment-provider agreement, tax treatment, branded workwear, verification SOPs, dispute policy, catalogue standards, security testing, operational dashboards.